MATHEW JOHN, JOINT DIRECTOR, SIB, TRIVANDRUM

Mathew John told the CBI that the IB got involved in the interrogation of Mariam Rasheeda on the request of Kerala Police. He, however, could not recollect the names of all the IB officers involved, but he named P B Sreekumar, deputy director, SIB, and some other subordinate officers.

Mathew John said he had sent a report to the IB headquarters in Delhi expressing the view that the facts disclosed by the accused persons were a mixture of half-truths and falsehood. He also stated that the involvement of Srivastava, IGP, was highlighted by the media but he did not take steps to verify the disclosures of the accused persons nor questioned Raman Srivastava in this regard. Though the name of Srivastava figured in the interrogation reports of Fauziyya and Rasheeda, the exact identity of Srivastava had not been established.

R B SREEKUMAR, DEPUTY DIRECTOR, SIB, TRIVANDRUM

Sreekumar said that whatever was stated by the accused persons were jotted down and a consolidated report was prepared in the evening. However, it was unsigned; the disclosures were not verified by the IB. He could not identify the IB officers involved in the preparation of the video tapes. He also declined to vouch for the genuineness of the video tapes because he had not seen them. He admitted that the IB does not have the legal authority to examine the accused when they are in the custody of the police.

C M RAVINDRAN, DEPUTY DIRECTOR, SIB, BOMBAY

Ravindran said till he was in Trivandrum interrogating Rasheeda, no espionage angle came to his notice. He had prepared a report in this regard